



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Writing Spot: Are you a team player?



Learning Outcome

Describe the reasons or results of events or actions in spoken or written texts, in work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- How do you respond in a team situation? Are you quiet? Are you a leader? Explain.
- Have you worked in a group that did not work well together? What happened?

Can Do Statements

- I can write about reasons and results of an event or action related to work and jobs.
- I can write about things, actions, events, or people in a work environment.
- I can write about team roles.





Let's Explore!

Employees possess a range of skills and attributes. When teams are formed, behavioral tensions and issues can **arise***.

* "To arise" means to begin to occur or exist.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Employing a cohesive group of individuals to work in a team is often said to be difficult. In fact, it is believed to be one of the most difficult challenges facing management. Wanting to focus on a person's education and skills, hiring managers often fail to consider behavior and personality traits when balancing a team. By understanding each role within a particular group, a person is able to develop their strengths and manage their weaknesses in a group environment. Teams can become unbalanced if all team members have similar styles of behavior or team roles. When having a team with varied strengths and experiences, management can expect greater cooperation and reduction of potential behavioral tensions. Roles can be broken down into three categories. Categories include action-oriented team members.

This group of individuals is believed to be the people who shape, implement and complete projects while driving a project from start to completion. Secondly, there are team-oriented roles such as coordinators, team-workers and resource investigators that provide support, assist in team cohesion and explore available options. Finally, there are thought-oriented roles that focus on new ideas and approaches, evaluate ideas and provide specialist knowledge. If you are thinking about developing a team before a project starts or want to further yourself as a team player, consider what your colleagues bring to the table. Observing individual members of your team over a period of time, and seeing how they contribute within the team environment can prove to be a fruitful exercise. After observing the team, keep a log or list of key strengths and traits that each team member has. Looking at the list, compare each person's strengths and weaknesses. Think about which roles and strengths you are lacking from your team. For example, is there a particular quality or strength shared by most of the team members, or is there a vital characteristic missing? Finding the right balance in staff is believed to be one of the most important factors in effective workplaces.





Let's Practice!

How can learning more about your workforce increase productivity and group cohesion?

Instructions: Find the words in the word search.

Words

1. developing
2. observing
3. seeing
4. having
5. understanding

M	Y	V	Y	T	J	B	I	A	O	O	J	G	Q	S
H	P	O	B	S	E	R	V	I	N	G	C	Z	U	H
I	Q	Y	L	Z	S	H	M	R	O	Y	D	O	N	X
D	M	X	R	K	D	Q	N	R	C	H	I	A	D	E
N	S	Y	X	S	E	O	A	A	J	A	L	X	E	F
S	E	Q	J	M	V	A	K	K	H	V	V	B	R	S
K	E	F	X	C	E	W	P	L	U	I	W	Y	R	U
A	I	T	X	R	L	M	N	J	T	N	T	I	T	E
T	N	E	D	J	O	Q	L	K	S	G	R	G	A	Q
M	G	X	L	U	P	P	T	M	T	G	W	L	N	N
H	N	B	W	P	I	R	H	F	P	M	W	J	D	O
P	R	J	U	P	N	J	R	H	W	W	I	D	I	C
P	F	R	N	P	G	H	B	S	L	G	L	S	N	D
N	C	D	B	T	S	W	T	K	A	H	A	I	G	D
A	Q	R	B	T	Z	K	W	Y	Y	J	S	Y	M	V



Let's Practice!

Each person enters a workplace with different skills, attributes and experiences.

Instructions: Imagine you have to create a team at work for a new project. There will be five people in the team. Would you prefer to have action-oriented, people-oriented, and thought-oriented team members or a balanced group? Using the information about the different types of roles individuals play in workplace environments, write a 120-150 word paragraph about who you would include.

Explain why you would choose people with these attributes.

Write about why having individuals with a range of skills and attributes is a good idea.

Include a topic sentence, supporting sentences and a concluding sentence. For example: Having a balanced team in a work environment is essential.





Extension Activity

How much do you know about workplace behaviors?

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Interview 5 people about how they behave in a work environment.
- Ask them to describe their behavior in a team. Are they shy? Loud? A person who makes sure everything gets done on time?
- Do any of the responses surprise you? Do some people behave differently at work?
- Ask each person to describe 3 behaviors that they believe are not helpful in a team.
- Write down their responses.
- Use all the information collected to write a paragraph about the importance of diverse personalities and attributes in the workplace.
- Read the paragraph aloud to a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I interview 5 people about their behavior in a work environment.

☐
☐

I write a paragraph using information about people's attributes and personalities.

☐
☐

I read my paragraph about team roles aloud to a partner.

☐
☐


Target Words

- **cohesive** (adjective): closely united
e.g. Employing a cohesive group of individuals to work in a team is often said to be difficult.
- **fruitful** (adjective): producing a good result; very productive
e.g. Seeing how they contribute within the team environment can prove to be a fruitful endeavor.
- **exercise** (noun): an activity that has a specified quality or result
e.g. Observing individual members of your team over a period of time can prove to be a fruitful exercise.
- **prevalent** (adjective): accepted, done, or happening often or over a large area at a particular time
e.g. Is there a prevalent team role that many of the team members share or are there particular roles missing from the group?
- **to shape** (verb): to influence the development of something
e.g. This group of individuals is believed to be the people who shape, implement, and complete projects while driving a project from start to completion.
- **oriented** (adjective): interested in a particular thing or activity
e.g. Categories include action-oriented team members.





Learning Points

Expressing Reason Relationships: Clauses Using -ing

You can express reasons in a variety of ways using linking words and phrases.

You can also use **-ing** clauses to express the relationship between two or more reasons. A **clause** is a part of a sentence. You may find two or more clauses in a sentence.

For example:

*We lined up for hours **hoping to get** his autograph!*

main clause: *We lined up for hours*

-ing clause: *hoping to get his autograph!*

If the **-ing** clause is placed at the beginning, a comma is needed between the clauses.

Example: *Feeling tired, I left the office early.*

When one action takes place before another, we use **having** + **past participle**.

Example:

***Having passed** my real estate exam, I thought I could start my own company.*

When you want to explain something or why somebody does something, you can use an **-ing** clause. Usually the -ing clause is placed first.

Example: *Not having a car, she couldn't attend church.*

Take a look at some other examples from the text:

Examples:

- *By observing individual members of your team over a period of time, you can understand each person's strengths.*
- *When having a team with varied strengths, management can expect a reduction of potential behavioral tensions.*
- *By understanding each role within a particular group, a person is able to develop their strengths in a group environment.*





Learning Points

Report Verbs with Impersonal Passive Construction

When you want to report a fact or belief, you can use a variety of ways to construct your ideas. When you do not want to mention the source of the information, you can use a passive structure.

You can use the structure **subject + passive verb + to-infinitive**.

For example:

It is believed to be the easiest move.

If necessary, you can express the agent.

For example:

It is believed by the managers to be the quickest fix.

Examples:

- *This group of individuals is believed to be the people who shape, implement and complete projects while driving a project from start to completion.*
- *Employing a cohesive group of individuals to work in a team is often said to be difficult.*
- *In fact, it is believed to be one of the most difficult challenges facing management.*
- *Finding the right balance in staff is believed to be one of the most important factors in effective workplaces.*
- *Tensions in the workplace are said to be the cause of significant stress.*

